INSTALL AND USER GUIDE

Bug Report for Google Chrome

Bug Report is a small add-on for Google Chrome. When something on a website goes wrong, or you wish it worked differently, you click one button. It takes a picture of the whole page, asks you two short questions, and saves your answers and the picture to a folder on your own PC. When you are ready, you zip that folder and send it to us.

YOU NEED
A Windows PC

BROWSER
Google Chrome

THE FILE
`BugReport-extension-1.2.2.zip`

TIME
About 5 minutes

Use Google Chrome only

Please install and use Bug Report in **Google Chrome**. Other browsers, such as Brave or Microsoft Edge, look similar but won't save your reports correctly. If you don't have Chrome yet, download it free from `google.com/chrome` and install it first.

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1 Create your reports folder

Do this first. Your reports need a folder of their own, and Chrome is fussy about where that folder lives.

1. Go to your Desktop, or another place you will remember.
2. Right-click an empty space and choose **New**, then **Folder**.
3. Name the new folder exactly `BUG_REPORTS` and press `Enter`.

Why a new folder? Chrome refuses to save into your Desktop, Documents or Downloads folders themselves. A folder *inside* one of them is fine. That is why `BUG_REPORTS` must be its own folder.

> You should see a new folder called **BUG_REPORTS** on your Desktop. Leave it empty. Bug Report fills it for you.

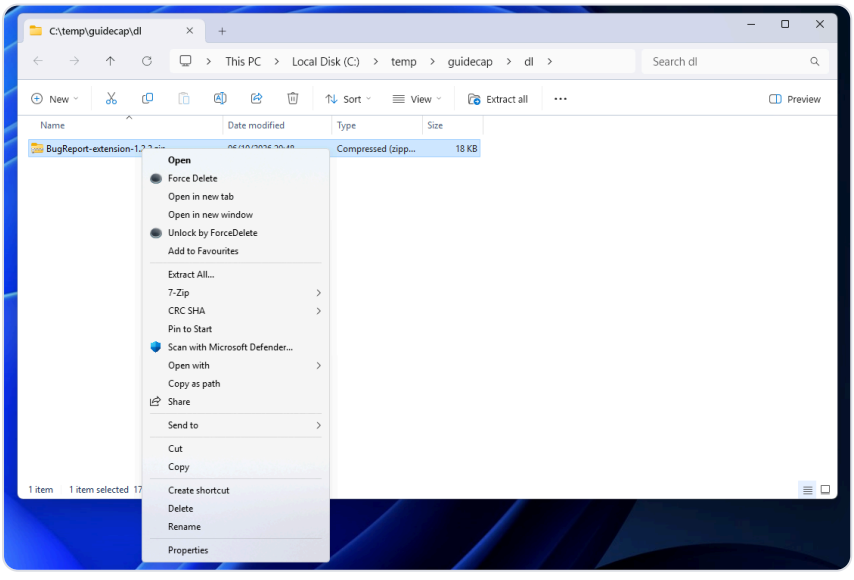
2 Unzip the extension

You received a file called `BugReport-extension-1.2.2.zip`. Chrome can't use the zip directly, so you need to unzip (extract) it first.

Unzip it somewhere permanent

Chrome runs Bug Report straight from the folder you unzip into. Put it somewhere it can stay, such as your **Documents** folder. Don't leave it in a temporary place, and don't delete or move that folder later. If you do, the extension stops working.

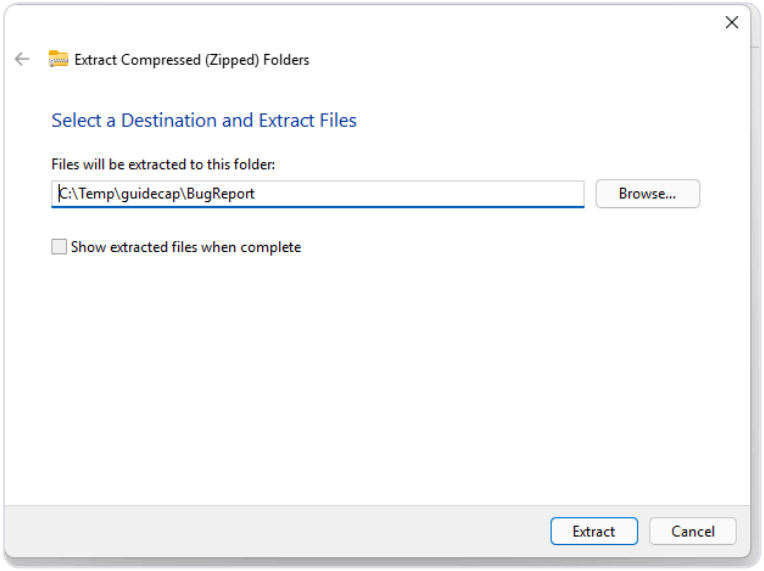
2a Right-click the zip file and choose Extract All...



Your menu may have different items in it. Look for Extract All.

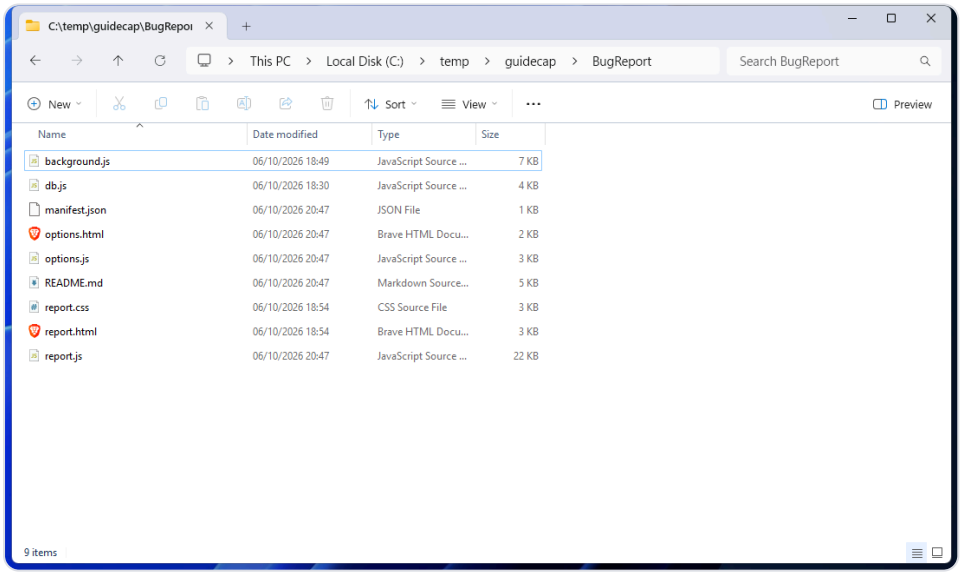
2b Choose where to put it, then click Extract

Click **Browse...** and pick your Documents folder, or type a path such as `C:\Users\YourName\Documents\BugReport`. The path in the picture below was only used for this guide, and yours will be different.



The Extract window. Check the path in the box, then click Extract.

2c Check the folder

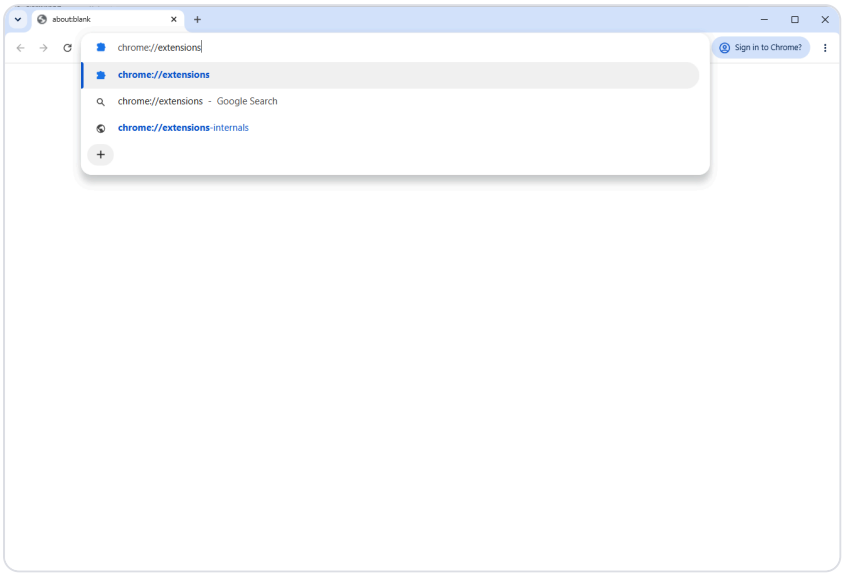


The unzipped folder. Remember where it is, as you will pick it in Step 5.

> You should see nine files, including one called **manifest.json**.

3 Open Chrome's extensions page

Open Google Chrome. Click in the address bar at the top, type `chrome://extensions` and press Enter.



Type chrome://extensions, then press Enter or click the top suggestion.

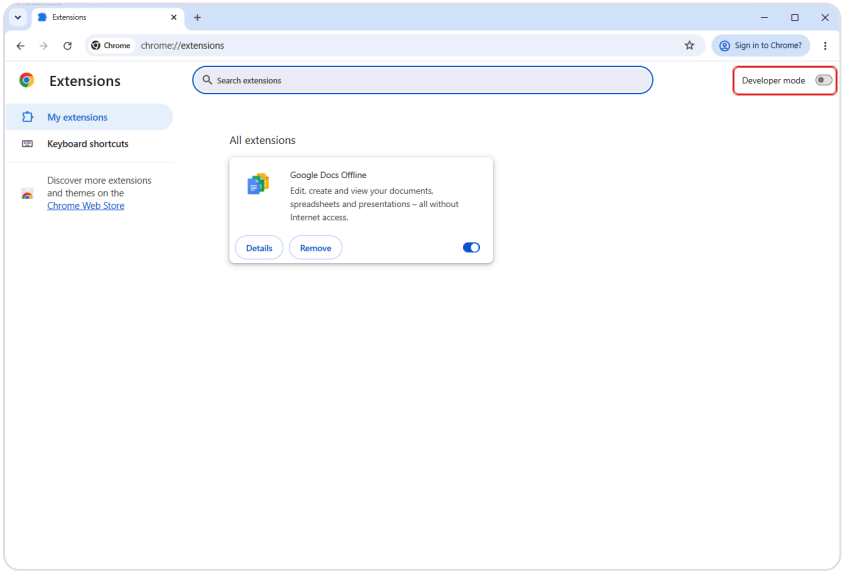
Another way: click the ⋮ menu (three dots, top right of Chrome), then **Extensions**, then **Manage Extensions**.

> You should see a page titled **Extensions**.

4 Turn on Developer mode

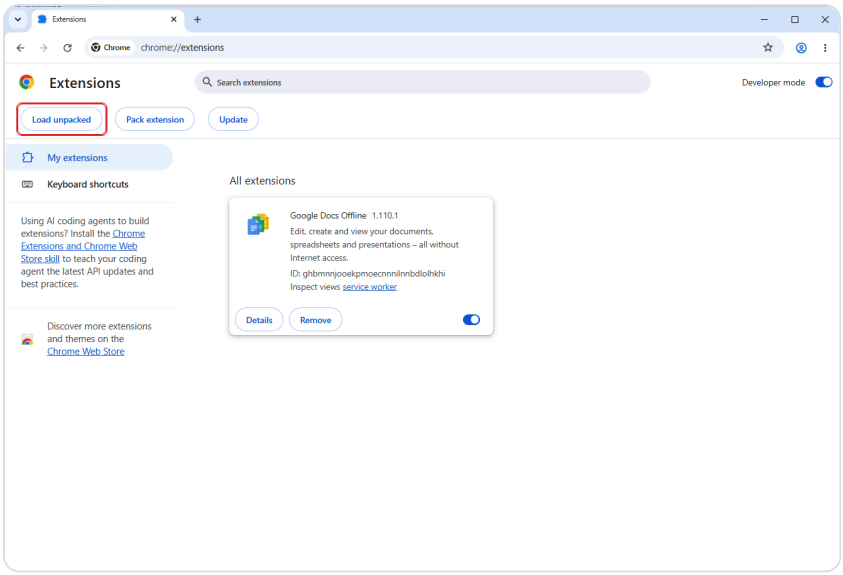
Bug Report is installed from a file rather than from the Chrome Web Store. Chrome only allows that when **Developer mode** is on. It is a normal Chrome setting and is safe to use.

4a Click the Developer mode switch at the top right



Developer mode is off. Click the switch.

4b Check it is on



Developer mode is on, and three new buttons appear.

> The switch turns blue, and the buttons **Load unpacked**, **Pack extension** and **Update** appear.

Leave Developer mode switched on. If you turn it off later, Chrome turns Bug Report off too.

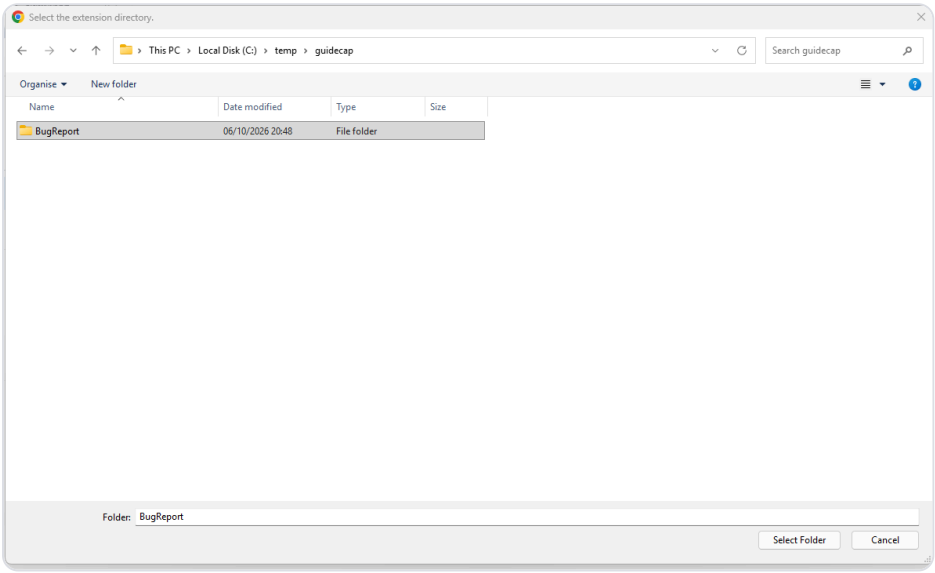
5 Load the extension

5a Click Load unpacked

It is the button highlighted in the picture in Step 4b. A window opens called "Select the extension directory."

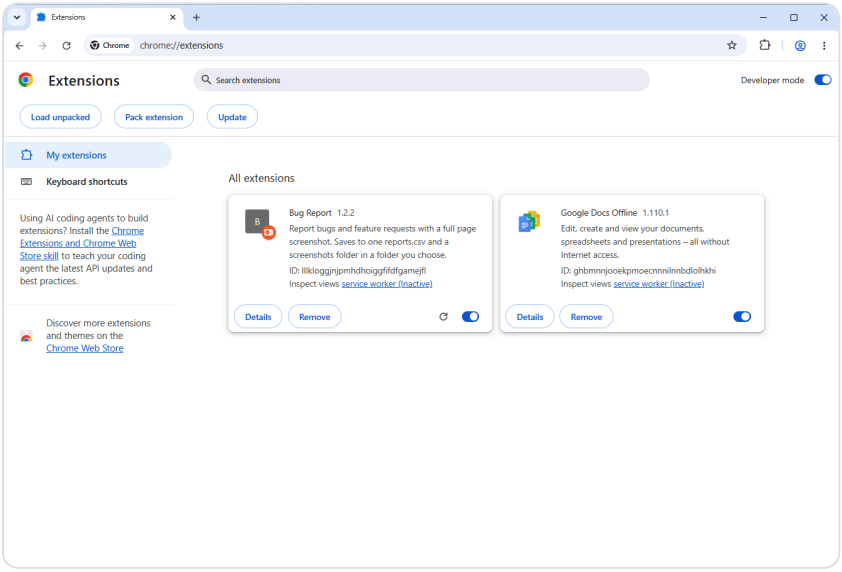
5b Pick the folder you unzipped in Step 2

Go to the folder you unzipped, the one that has **manifest.json** inside it. Click it once so it is highlighted, then click **Select Folder**.



"Select the extension directory." Highlight the unzipped folder and click Select Folder.

5c Check it has loaded



Bug Report is now listed on the Extensions page.

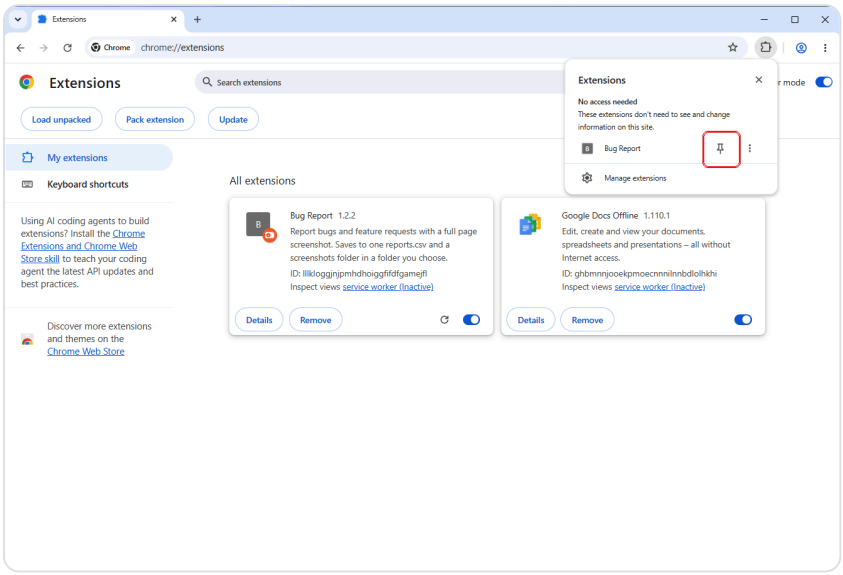
> You should see a card called **Bug Report 1.2.2** with its blue switch turned on.

6 Pin the button to your toolbar

Pinning puts the Bug Report button next to the address bar, so it is always one click away.

6a Click the puzzle piece, then the pin next to Bug Report

The puzzle piece icon is at the top right of Chrome, next to the address bar. In the list that opens, click the **pin** icon on the Bug Report row.



Click the pin next to Bug Report.

6b Check the button is there



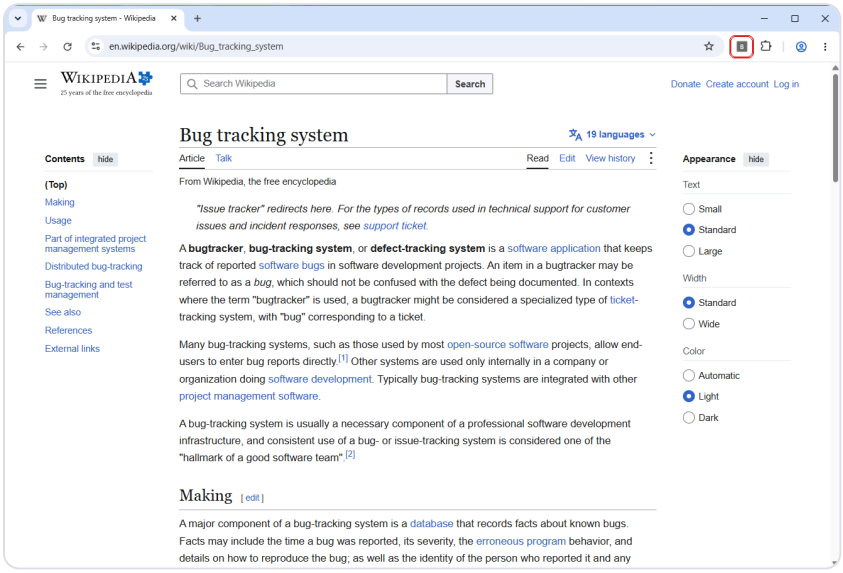
The grey **B** button is Bug Report.

> You should see a small grey **B** button at the top right of Chrome. That's it, Bug Report is installed.

7 Your first report

The first report takes a few extra clicks, because you tell Chrome which folder to save into. After that, it is much quicker.

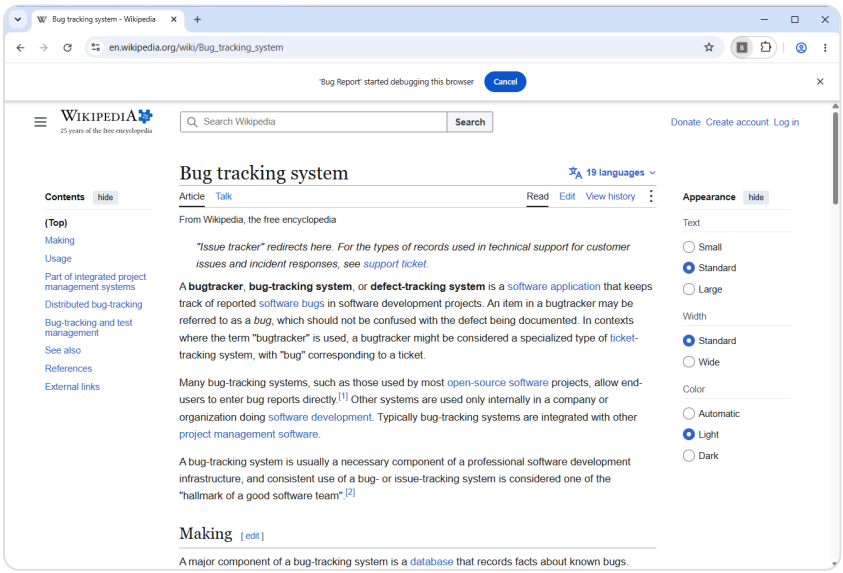
7a Go to the page with the problem and click the B button



Any website will do. This example uses a Wikipedia page.

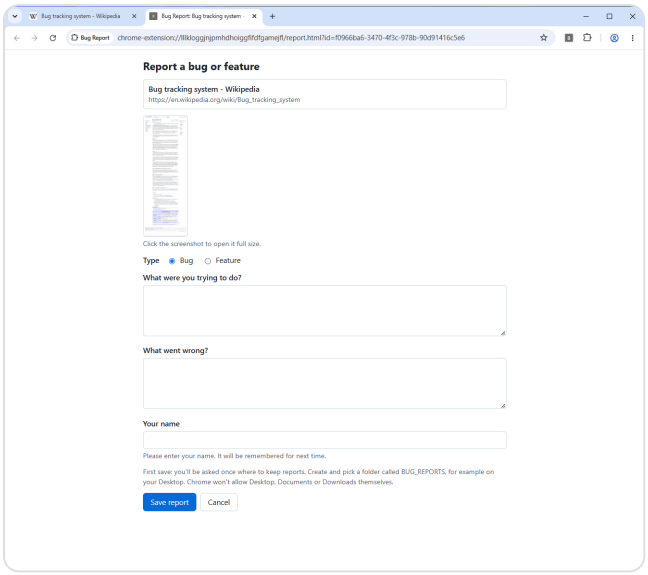
7b Wait a moment while it takes the picture

A bar appears at the top of the page saying **'Bug Report' started debugging this browser**, with a **Cancel** button. This is normal. Chrome shows it every time Bug Report takes a full-page picture. It closes by itself after a few seconds. Please don't click Cancel.



The debugging bar is expected. It goes away on its own.

7c A new tab opens with your report form

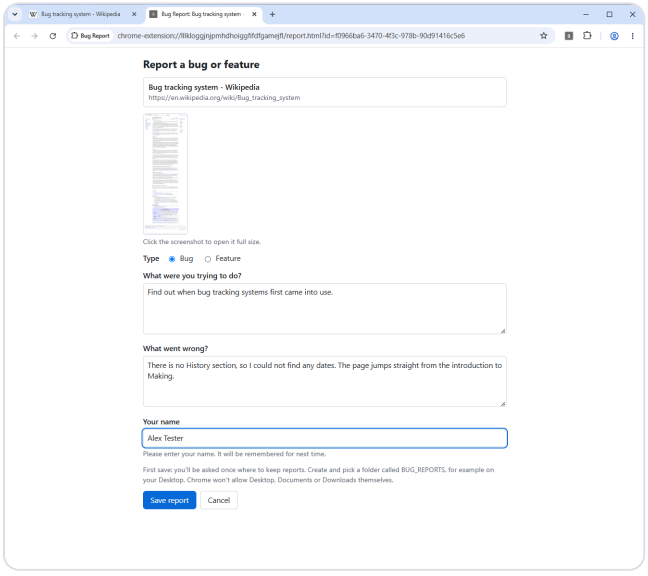


The report form. The small picture is the screenshot. Click it to see it full size.

> You should see **Report a bug or feature**, the page's name and address, and a small picture of the page.

7d Fill in the form

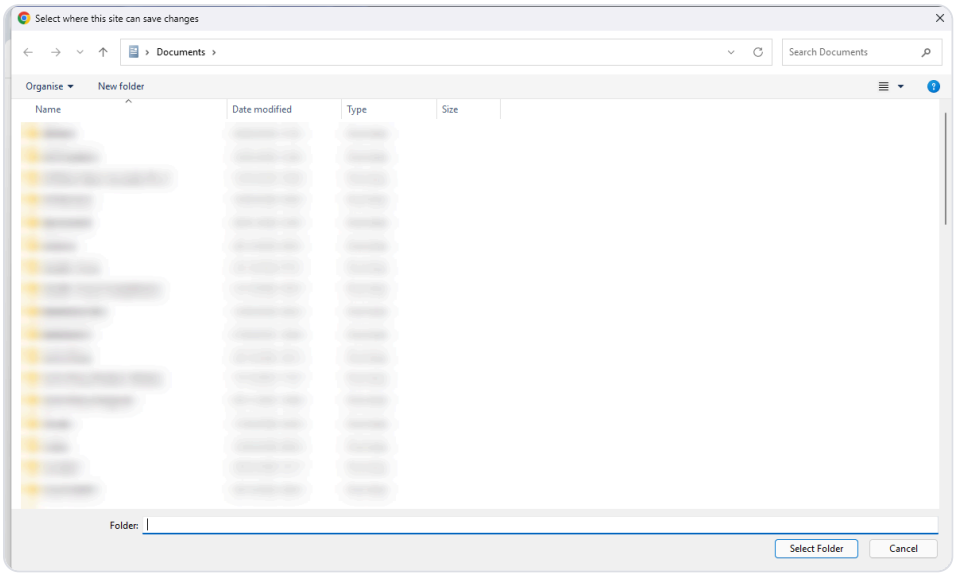
Choose **Bug** or **Feature** at **Type**. Answer both questions and type your name. Then click **Save report**. See section 11 for tips on good answers.



A filled-in Bug report, ready to save.

7e Chrome asks where to save

A window opens called "Select where this site can save changes". It may open in your Documents folder, as here.

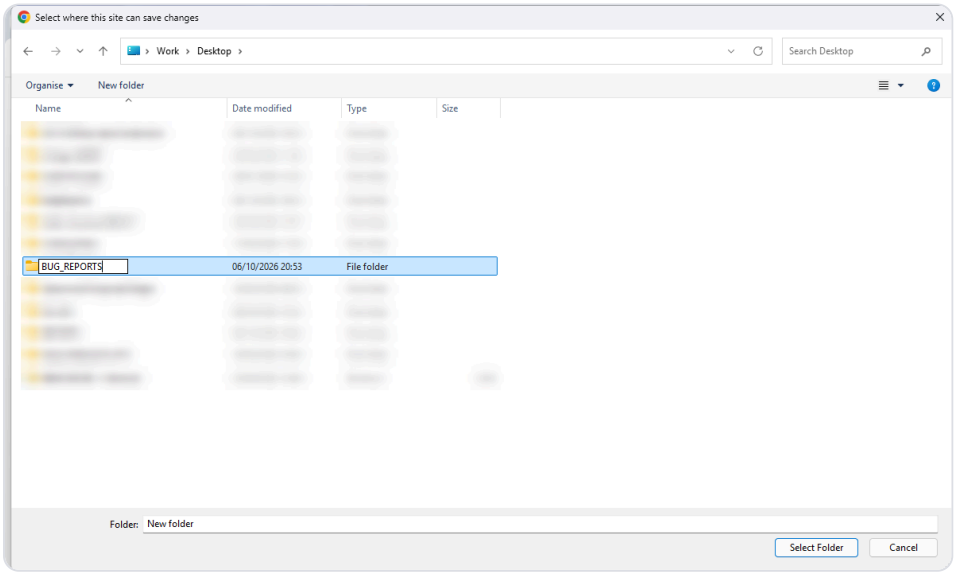


"Select where this site can save changes".

7f Go to your BUG_REPORTS folder

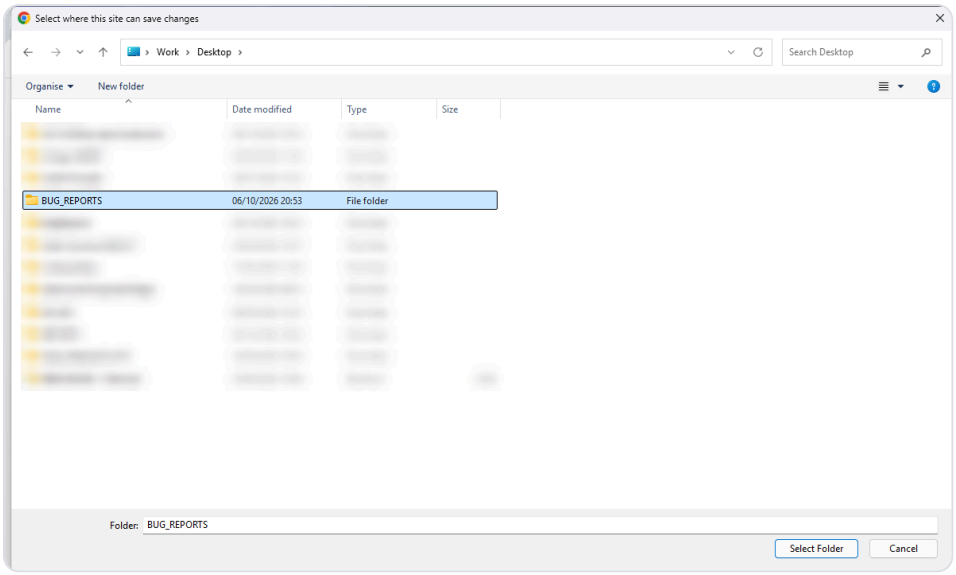
Find the `BUG_REPORTS` folder you made in Step 1. If you made it on your Desktop, click **Desktop** in the list on the left of the window.

If you skipped Step 1, you can make the folder here instead. Go to your Desktop, click **New folder**, type `BUG_REPORTS` and press `Enter`.



Only if you skipped Step 1: making the folder from inside the save window.

7g Click BUG_REPORTS once, then click Select Folder

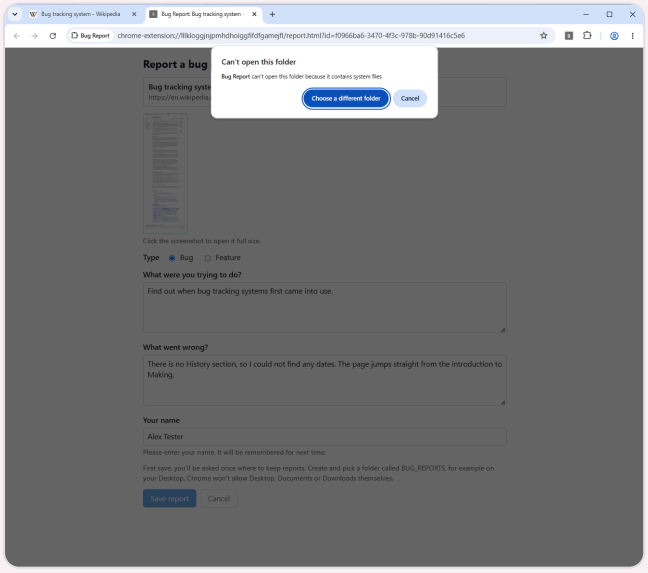


The Folder box at the bottom should say BUG_REPORTS.

> Check that the **Folder:** box at the bottom says **BUG_REPORTS** before you click Select Folder.

If you see "Can't open this folder"

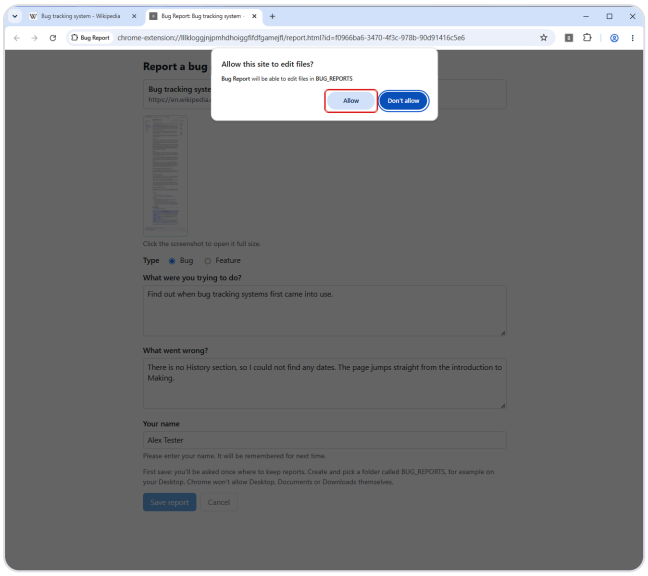
The message says "Bug Report can't open this folder because it contains system files". It means you picked Desktop, Documents or Downloads itself, rather than the folder inside it. Click **Choose a different folder** and pick `BUG_REPORTS`.



Click Choose a different folder, then pick BUG_REPORTS.

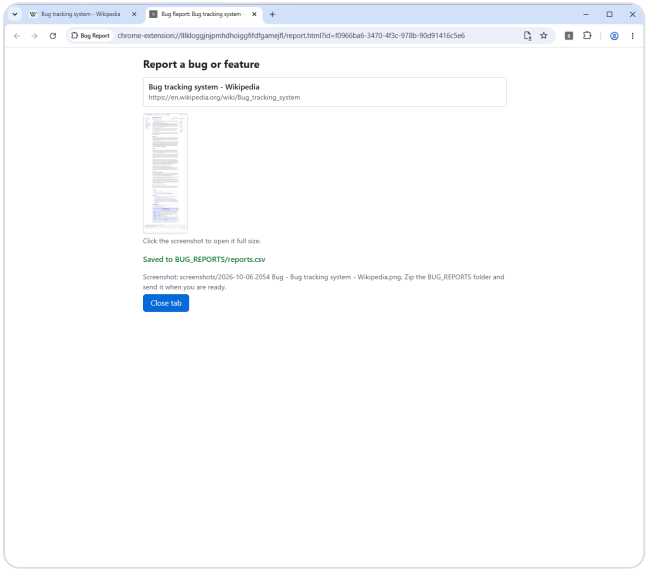
7h Click Allow

Chrome asks "Allow this site to edit files?" and says "Bug Report will be able to edit files in BUG_REPORTS". Click **Allow**. This only lets Bug Report write into that one folder.



Click Allow, not Don't allow.

7i Your report is saved



Saved. You can click Close tab.

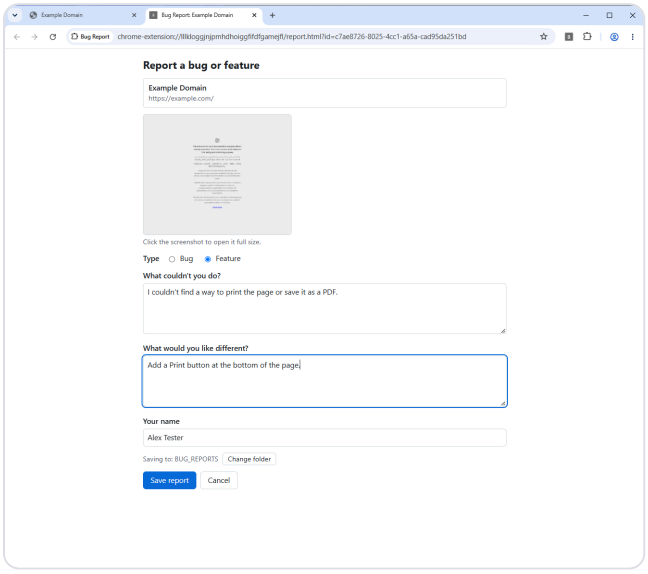
> You should see the green message **Saved to BUG_REPORTS/reports.csv**. Below it is a line starting "Screenshot: screenshots/" with the picture's name, ending "Zip the BUG_REPORTS folder and send it when you are ready." Click **Close tab** to go back to what you were doing.

8 Your second report

Your next report has one more question from Chrome. Answer it the right way and you won't be asked again.

8a Make a report as before and click Save report

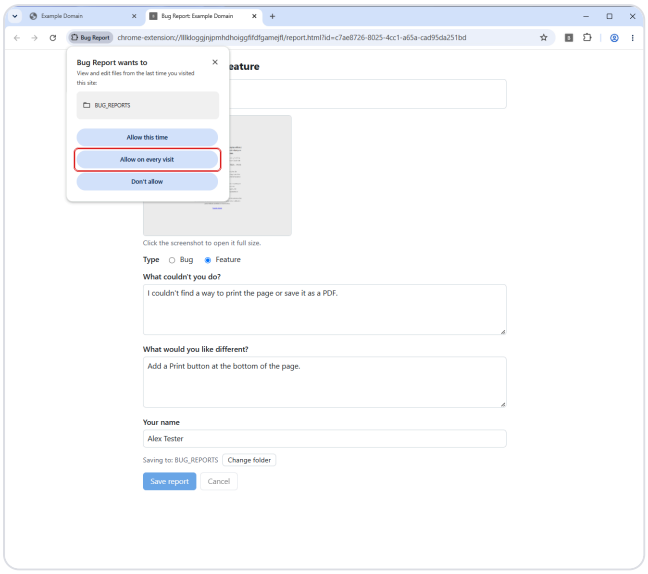
Click the **B** button on the page, fill in the form and click Save report. This time the form shows **Saving to: BUG_REPORTS**, and your name is already filled in.



A Feature report. Note the Saving to line and the Change folder button.

8b Click Allow on every visit

A box appears at the top left saying "Bug Report wants to" and "View and edit files from the last time you visited this site:", with `BUG_REPORTS` below. There are three buttons.

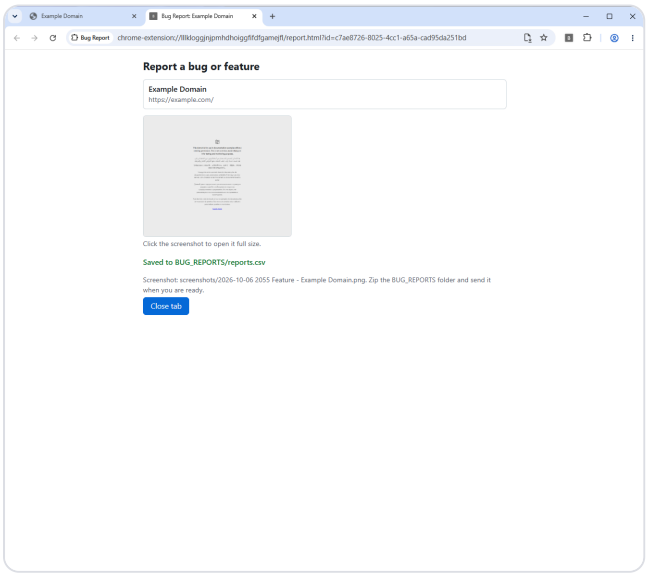


Choose the middle button, Allow on every visit.

Choose "Allow on every visit", not "Allow this time"

Allow on every visit means Chrome remembers your choice, and you won't see this box again. If you pick **Allow this time**, Chrome will ask you again on every single report.

8c Saved again



The second report is saved in the same folder.

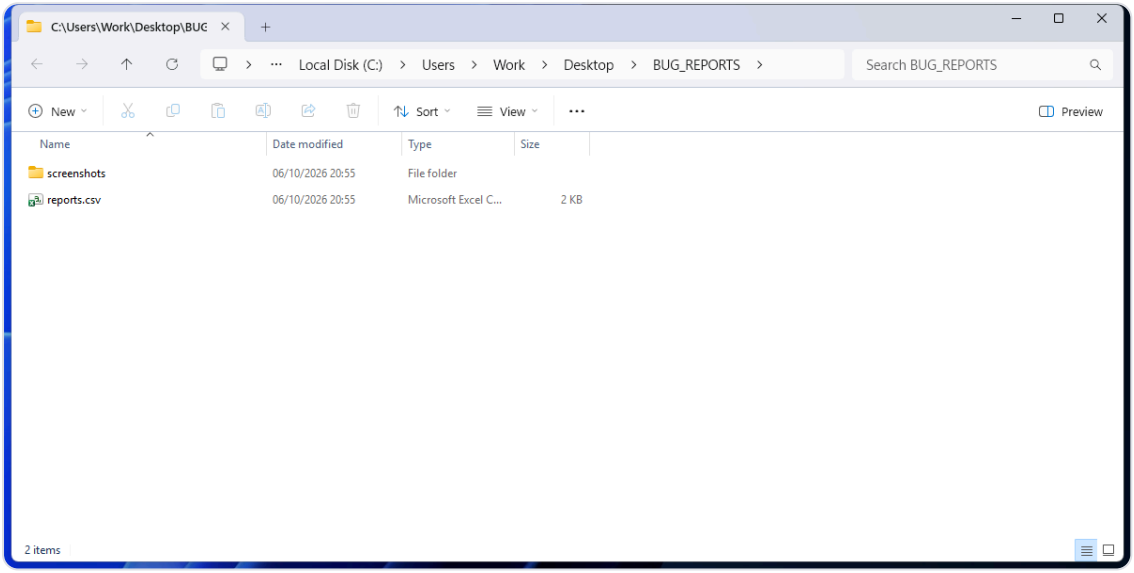
> From now on there are no more prompts. You click the B button, answer the questions and click Save report.

9 Where your reports are kept

Open your `BUG_REPORTS` folder in File Explorer. All your reports are in it.

```
BUG_REPORTS
  reports.csv       one row per report, opens in Excel
  screenshots
    2026-10-06 2054 Bug - Bug tracking system - Wikipedia.png
    2026-10-06 2055 Feature - Example Domain.png
```

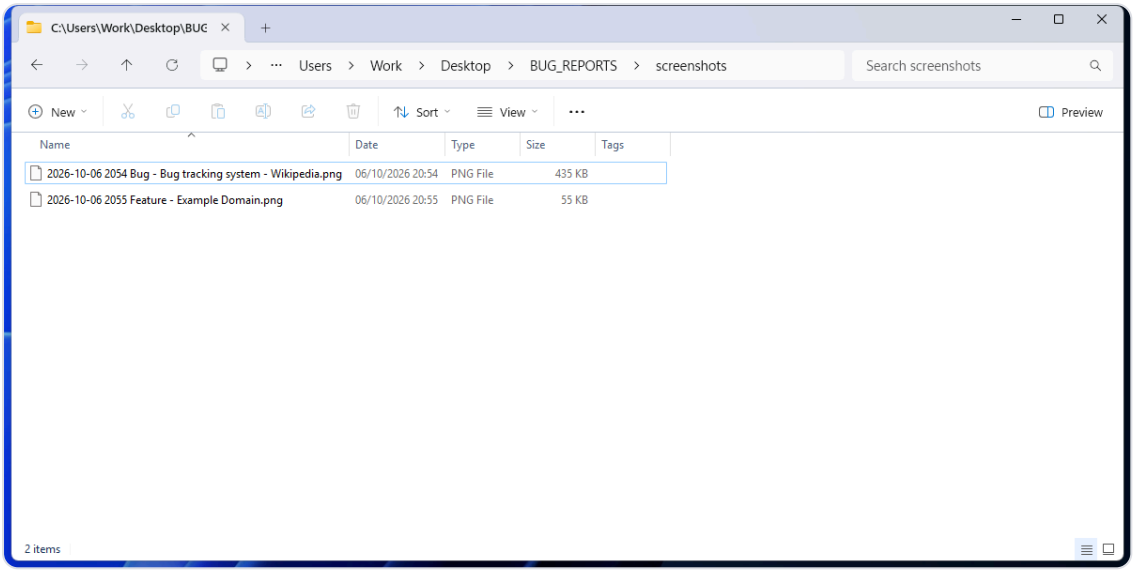
9a The folder holds one list and one folder of pictures



Inside BUG_REPORTS: the screenshots folder and reports.csv.

9b The screenshots folder holds the pictures

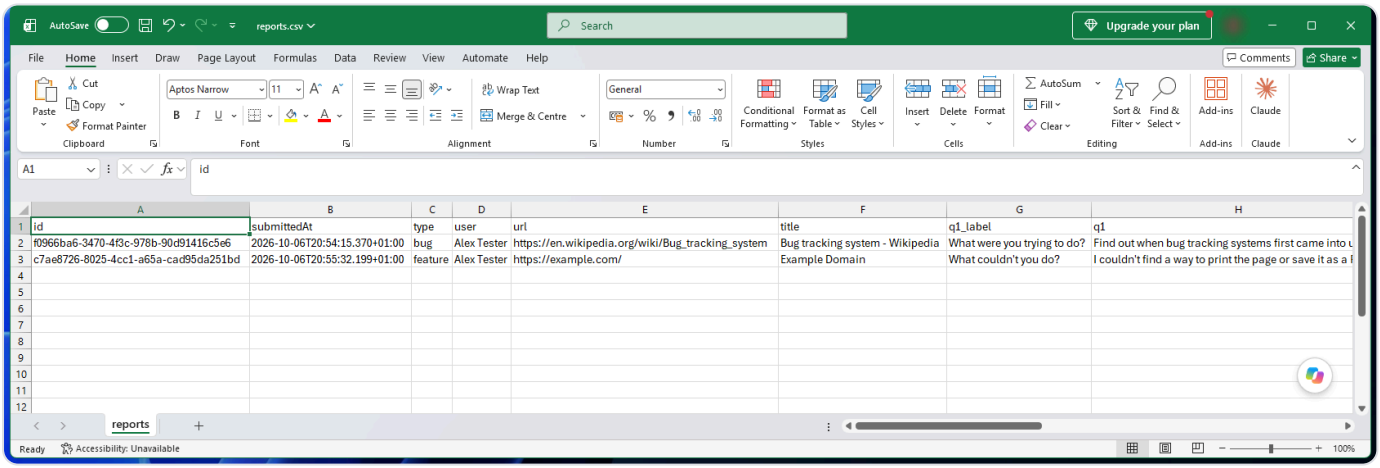
Each picture is named with the date, time, type and page title, so they are easy to tell apart.



One picture per report.

9c reports.csv has one row per report

Double-click `reports.csv` to open it in Excel. Each row is one report, with your answers, the page address, your name and the name of its screenshot.



reports.csv in Excel, with one row for each of the two reports.

10 Sending your reports

When you are ready to send your reports, zip the whole folder.

1. Right-click the `BUG_REPORTS` folder.
2. Choose **Send to**, then **Compressed (zipped) folder**. On Windows 11 you may need to click **Show more options** first. Or choose **Compress to ZIP file** if you see it.
3. A new file called `BUG_REPORTS.zip` appears next to the folder.
4. Email or upload that zip file, as you have been asked to.

Keep collecting reports in the same `BUG_REPORTS` folder afterwards. New reports are added to the list, and nothing already in it is changed.

11 Bug or Feature, and writing good answers

Pick the type that fits, and the questions change to match.

Type	Use it when	Question 1	Question 2
Bug	Something is broken or doesn't work as it should.	What were you trying to do?	What went wrong?
Feature	It works, but you wish it did something more or different.	What couldn't you do?	What would you like different?

Tips for good answers

- **Be specific.** "The Save button on the Contact page does nothing" helps far more than "saving is broken".
- **Give the steps.** Say what you clicked, in order, so someone else can make the same thing happen.
- **Say what you expected.** Then say what happened instead. Copy any error message word for word.
- **One issue per report.** If you find three problems, make three reports. Each one gets its own picture.
- **Report from the right page.** Click the B button while the problem is on screen, so the picture shows it.

12 Handy extras

Keyboard shortcut

Instead of clicking the B button, you can press Alt + Shift + B on the page you want to report.

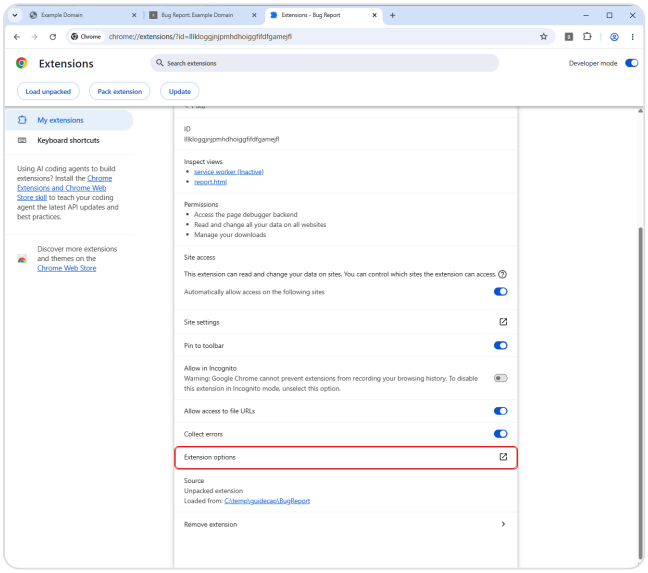
Your name

You only type your name once. Bug Report remembers it after your first report and fills it in for you next time.

Changing the folder

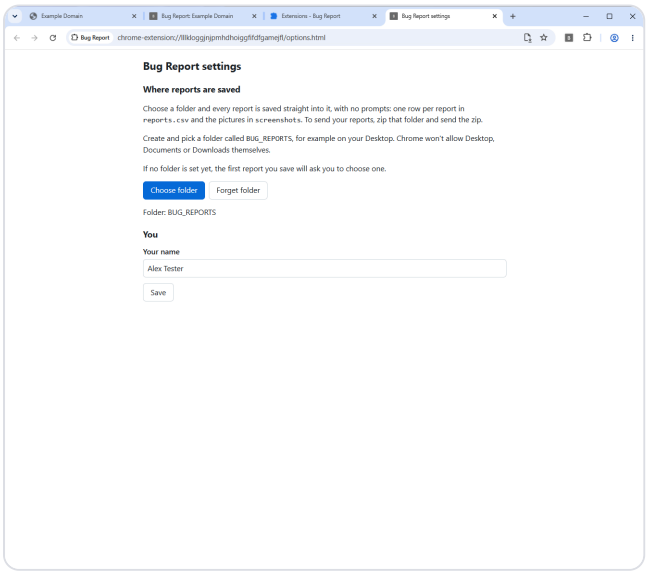
To save into a different folder, click **Change folder** next to "Saving to:" on the report form (you can see it in Step 8a). Pick the new folder in the same way as before.

You can also change it in the extension's settings page. Go to `chrome://extensions`, click **Details** on the Bug Report card, scroll down and click **Extension options**.



Details, then Extension options.

The settings page shows where reports are saved. It has a **Choose folder** button to pick a folder, a **Forget folder** button to clear it, and a box for your name with a **Save** button.



The settings page. The Folder line shows which folder is in use.

13 Troubleshooting and questions

Chrome asks for permission every time I save a report.

You probably chose "Allow this time". Next time the box appears, choose **Allow on every visit**. See section 8. After a full restart of Chrome it may ask once more. Choose Allow on every visit again.

It says "Can't open this folder".

You picked Desktop, Documents or Downloads itself. Click **Choose a different folder** and pick the `BUG_REPORTS` folder inside it. See section 7.

I clicked "Don't allow" by mistake.

Nothing was saved, and your answers are still on the form. Click **Save report** again and choose **Allow** this time. The form may also show **Try again** and **Choose another folder** buttons. Either one works. You can also use **Change folder** to pick the folder again.

I closed the folder window without choosing a folder.

Nothing was saved yet. Click **Save report** again and the window opens again.

It says "No screenshot could be taken".

Chrome doesn't let any extension take pictures of its own pages, such as `chrome://` pages or the Chrome Web Store. This is expected. The report still saves, just without a picture.

A bar says "'Bug Report' started debugging this browser".

That's normal. Chrome shows it whenever Bug Report takes a full-page picture. It closes by itself after a few seconds. Please don't click Cancel while it is showing.

The picture of a very long page is cut off.

Very long pages are cut off at about 16,000 pixels tall. The form tells you when this happens. If the problem is further down, scroll to it and mention where it is in your answer.

The B button has disappeared, or Bug Report is turned off.

Go to `chrome://extensions` and check two things. First, **Developer mode** must still be on (Step 4). Second, the folder you unzipped in Step 2 must still be where it was. If it was moved or deleted, unzip the file again and repeat Step 5. If Bug Report is listed but switched off, turn its blue switch back on. If it is on but not in the toolbar, pin it again (Step 6).

Can I use Brave, Microsoft Edge or another browser?

Please use Google Chrome. Other browsers handle the save folder differently, and your reports may not save correctly. Get Chrome free from `google.com/chrome`.

Is anything sent over the internet? What about my privacy?

No. Bug Report doesn't send anything anywhere. Your reports and pictures stay on your PC, in your `BUG_REPORTS` folder, until you zip the folder and send it yourself. The picture only shows the page you were on when you clicked the button, so check it doesn't show anything private before you send it.

Chrome warns that Bug Report can "read and change all your data on all websites".

Chrome shows this because Bug Report needs permission to take a full-page picture of whatever page you are on. It only does this when you click the B button or press the shortcut, and only on that tab.